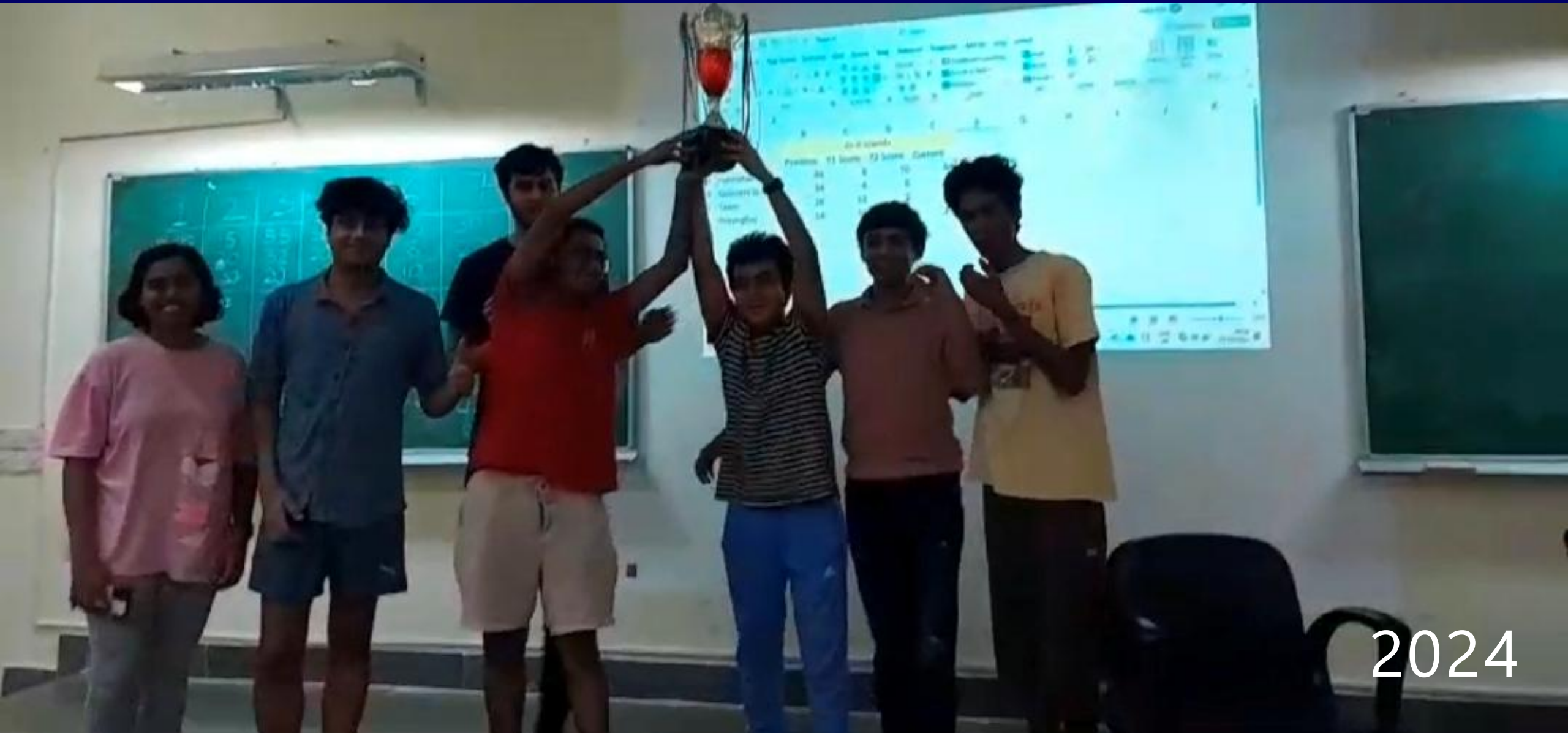


BITS Quizzing League 2026 Finals

Legacy Quiz

Prayag Mohanty

Past BQL Winners



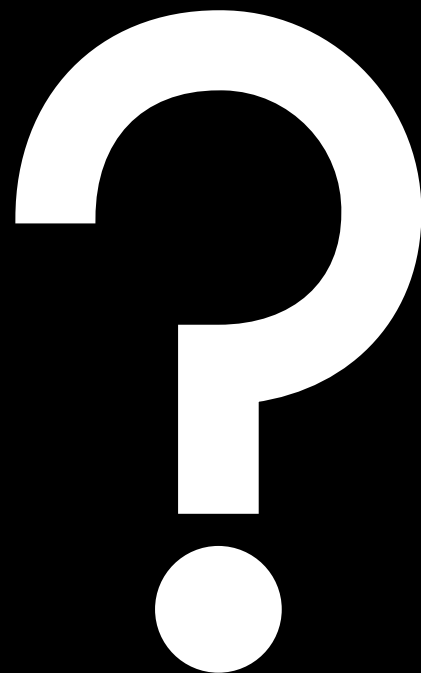
2024

Past BQL Winners



2025

Past BQL Winners



2026

Acknowledgements

- Some of the questions have been sourced from Samanway, Major, Ravi Mundoli & Navin Jayaram's sets, that I've attended. Huge shoutout to them!
- Rest of the questions, are set by moi
- Thanks to Divyanshu & Amit for GPing the set.

Endgame

4 Rounds

1. Theme Round – 5 questions
2. Clockwise Round – 12 questions
3. Written Round – 4 questions
4. Anti-Clockwise Round – 12 questions

Lessgooo!

Round 1

- Written Round
- Theme – BQL
- 5 questions
- Every correct answer fetches 10 points
- No negatives

CCD was founded by VG Siddhartha, who died in 2019.

Kuppalli is a small village in the Thirthahalli taluk of Karnataka's Shivamogga district. It is best known as the childhood home of a towering figure, buried not far from his ancestral residence. His resting place, named Kavishaila, sits atop a small hillock. The memorial, composed of large stone slabs, has him laid to rest at its very center. VG Siddhartha was responsible for financing the memorial of this literary legend.

Whose grave is this? What inspired the design of the memorial?

In 2021, 90-year-old William Shatner — best known as the fictional character— became the oldest person to ride a rocket into space, aboard a Blue Origin capsule owned by Jeff Bezos. Bezos is a huge fan of the fictional series.

The fictional character is known as the commander of a starship.

Which series?

"Jizz in My Pants" is an *SNL* Digital Short which aired on *Saturday Night Live* on 2008.

It required the then-CEO of NBC's personal approval to air because of its title. The comedy song launched a career that would eventually lead its star to play a New York City detective on a beloved police sitcom.

Who?

"Quid pro quo" is a Latin phrase meaning "something for something" — an exchange where one thing is given in return for another.

The same phrase is rephrased in slang as ___ ___ ___, which is often used in a revengeful context.

Both words are just an old dialectal variant of "tip," meaning a light knock.

What phrase?

One unexpected casualty of the Epstein files was a 90-year-old company called Lifetouch.

Its indirect link to Epstein & the company's entire business made parents panic. So, in early 2026, school districts across the United States began cancelling their annual contracts with Lifetouch.

What does Lifetouch do?

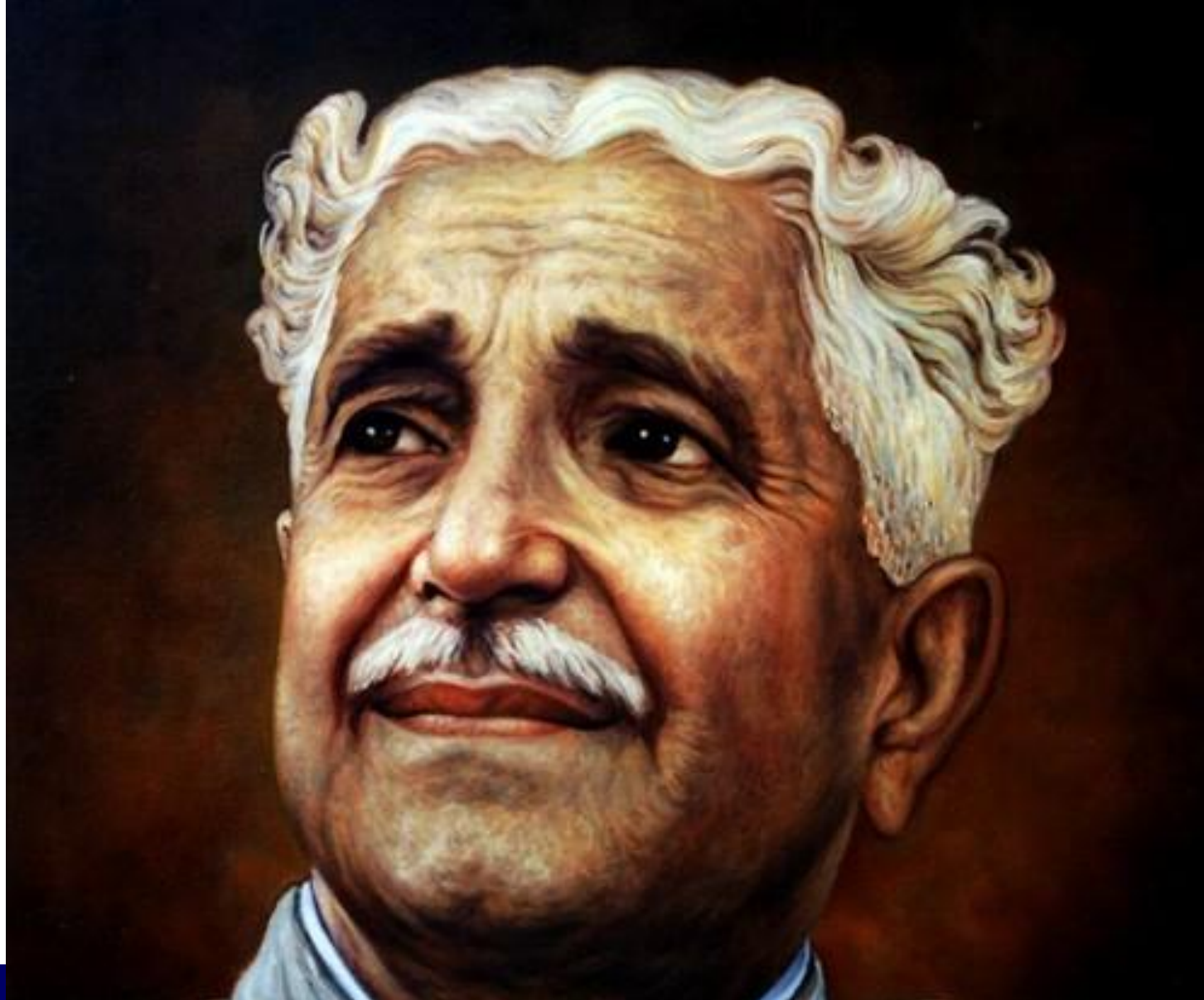
Exchange Answers

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Whose grave is this? What inspired the design of the memorial?

Kuvempu, regarded as the greatest Kannada poet of the 20th century



Kuvempu's memorial is based on the Stonehenge



In 2021, 90-year-old William Shatner — best known as the fictional character— became the oldest person to ride a rocket into space, aboard a Blue Origin capsule owned by Jeff Bezos. Bezos is a huge fan of the fictional series.

The fictional character is known as the commander of a starship.

Which series?

Star Trek



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It required the then-CEO of NBC's personal approval to air because of its title. The comedy song launched a career that would eventually lead its star to play a New York City detective on a beloved police sitcom.

Who?

Andy Samberg



“Quid pro quo” is a Latin phrase meaning “something for something” — an exchange where one thing is given in return for another.

The same phrase is rephrased in slang as ___ __ ___, which is often used in a revengeful context.

Both words are just an old dialectal variant of “tip,” meaning a light knock. Nothing NSFW about it.

What phrase?

Tit for tat

***TIT
FOR
TAT***

vevo

One unexpected casualty of the Epstein files was a 90-year-old company called Lifetouch.

It's indirect link to Epstein & the company's entire business - made parents panic. So, in early 2026, school districts across the United States began canceling their annual contracts with Lifetouch.

What does Lifetouch do?

School photos



Round 2

- Clockwise Round
- 12 questions
- Bounce: +10/0
- Pounce: +10/-5

This is a watercolor on display at the Metropolitan Museum of Art titled *Packing _____ in Canton for Shipment to the West* which shows one of the main exports of Ming and early Qing period (1644-1911) China. The goods were packed carefully owing to their delicate nature, and something was used as a filler for cushioning.

Ironically, from the 18th century, the roles were reversed. The filler material became the more precious commodity, and the previously traded item became ballast to stabilize the ships that carried it.

What are these items and commodity which swapped roles? [2 x 5]





Answer Slide

Porcelain (chinaware, ceramic), tea

Tea leaves were used as filler & discarded later in Europe, possibly contributing to its popularity



Most of us would have encountered this creation (and possibly enjoyed the “experience”), mostly during an annoying occurrence. It was created by Sebastien Gabriel, Alan Bettes, and Edward Jung in 2014. During development, it was referred to as 'Project Bolan', a nod to lead singer Marc Bolan of a particular (relevant) band.

By design, the entire “experience” is meant to last for 17 million years, so no one will ever enjoy the complete package.

What creation is this? [4]

Why the choice of 17 million years? [6]

Answer Slide

T-Rex game, They survived for 17 million years



The idiom originated in the United States in the 1920s, stemming from the rise of newly electrified household appliances. It uses the metaphor of an immediate, automatic action triggered by a simple press to mean intentionally eliciting a strong emotional response or reaction, typically annoyance or anger.

It is only appropriate that the weekly video games newsletter of The Guardian is named after this idiom.

What two-word title is this?

Answer Slide

Pushing Buttons

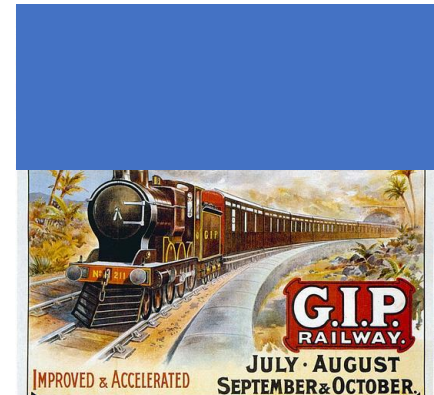


From July 1905 onwards, the Great Indian Peninsula Railway ran a special train on 26 days over 13 weeks from July to October. Rich folks from Bombay would put in a morning's worth of work, board the train at noon, and be at their destination by 3 pm.

The next few hours would be spent in a pastime that the destination had become famous for. They could then board the return train, have dinner, and be home in time for bed.

What was the destination? [5]

Why were these moneybags traveling there? [5]





G.I.P. RAILWAY.

JULY · AUGUST
SEPTEMBER & OCTOBER.

IMPROVED & ACCELERATED

**COMPOSED OF HANDSOME NEW VESTIBULED CARS
SPECIALLY CONSTRUCTED FOR THIS SERVICE:
ELECTRIC LIGHT & POWERFUL FANS.**

RESTAURANT

RECLINING CHAIRS
LADIES' BOUDOIR
PRIVATE DRESSING ROOMS
BATH & C.

"A CLUB ON WHEELS"

THE FINEST PASSENGER TRAIN IN INDIA

TIME TABLE

1 ST CLASS		2 ND CLASS	
DOWN TRAIN	UP TRAIN	DOWN TRAIN	UP TRAIN
VICTORIA TERMINUS BOMBAY W. R. 12·0	W. R. 19·30	VICTORIA TERMINUS BOMBAY W. R. 11·25	W. R. 19·55
W. R. 15·0	VICTORIA TERMINUS BOMBAY W. R. 23·0	W. R. 14·30	VICTORIA TERMINUS BOMBAY W. R. 23·30

RETURN FARES

FOR PASSENGER		FOR PASSENGER WITH ADMISSION TO SECOND CLASS ENCLOSURE	
WITH ADMISSION TO GRAND STAND	WITHOUT ADMISSION TO GRAND STAND	WITH ADMISSION TO GRAND STAND	WITHOUT ADMISSION TO GRAND STAND
Rs. 17·0·0	Rs. 12·0·0	Rs. 11·8·0	Rs. 6·8·0
		8·0·0	6·8·0

DOMESTIC SERVANTS ONLY 3RD CLASS 4 0 0

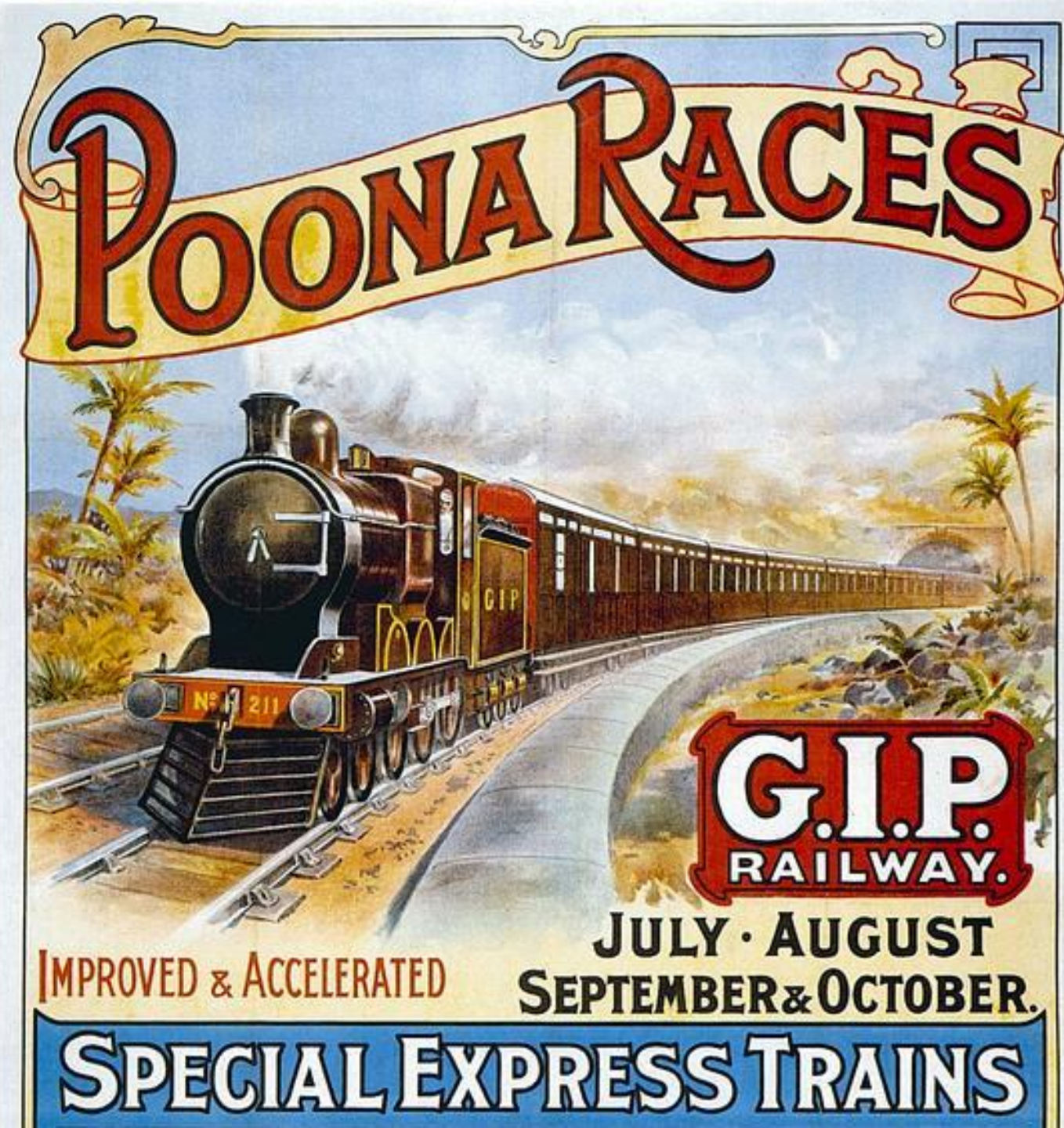
RESTAURANT TARIFF.

LUNCH	Rs. 1·8·0	LUNCH	Rs. 1·0·0
DINNER	3·0·0	DINNER	2·0·0

A. MUIRHEAD, General Traffic Manager, BOMBAY.

Answer Slide

Poona Races



The Mauch Chunk Gravity Railway in Pennsylvania was originally built in the 1820s and 30s to transport coal from the Summit Hill mines to the Lehigh River. It was not operational on weekends, and the people who ran the hill soon began opening it to onlookers as a way to make some extra money. Other railway companies soon followed suit.

All of this inspired the inventor LaMarcus Thompson to set up an attraction modeled on similar principles at Coney Island, leading to several such "scenic railways" being established across the United States.

What is this railway considered the first ever example of in the US?





Ch. Bolander pinx. del. sculp.

Imp. de la Haye.

Wider. 1800.

ANSICHT VON MAUCH-CHUNK.
(Pennsylvanien)

VUE DE MAUCH-CHUNK.
(Pennsylvanie)

VIEW OF MAUCH-CHUNK.

Answer Slide

Rollercoasters

The Mauch Chunk Railroad was a 9-mile downhill stretch that used gravity to propel the carts



The Anglo-American ____ Chess matches were a series of yearly chess matches played between teams from the US and UK from 1896 to 1911. The matches were made possible by the completion of a technological project involving the ship *SS Great Eastern* (among others) in the 1860s.

The mementos/trophies issued as part of these events paid tribute to the technology itself.

FITB. [4]

What is special about the mementos/trophies? [6]





Answer Slide

Cable/telegraph lines

Cross section of the cable lines were
part of the mementos



X Y is a poem by 4-time individual National Poetry Slam champion Patricia Smith. In this poem, she deftly mixes 2 genres X and Y of written and spoken/sung word to create a nice fusion.

Watch the video and name the poem. [2 x 5]

[Answer will be of the form 'Techno Sonnet']



Shapes and Shadows

by Neil Stowart

watching colors from watching
nothing. A soft glow within us, a
quiet center, a world, a new way
looking inside a different world in the
momentary. ... watching colors shadows
and, watch a particular thing, person
disappear within the world. It goes for
colors, it comes to go around.





Gotta love us brown girls, munching on fat, swinging blue hips,
decked out in shells and splashes, Lawdie, bringing them woo hips.

As the jukebox teases, watch my sistas throat the heartbreak,
inhaling bassline, cracking backbone and singing thru hips.

Like something boneless, we glide silent, seeping 'tween floorboards,
wrapping around the hims, and *ooh wee*, clinging like glue hips.

Engines grinding, rotating, smokin', gotta pull back some.
Natural minds are lost at the mere sight of ringing true hips.

Gotta love us girls, just struttin' down Manhattan streets
killing the menfolk with a dose of that stinging view. Hips.

Crying 'bout getting old—Patricia, you need to get up off
what God gave you. Say a prayer and start slinging. Cue hips.

Answer Slide

Hip-Hop ghazal

The vibe is hip-hop but the rhyming scheme (especially the refrain, poet's name) is ghazal

Hip-Hop Ghazal

BY PATRICIA SMITH

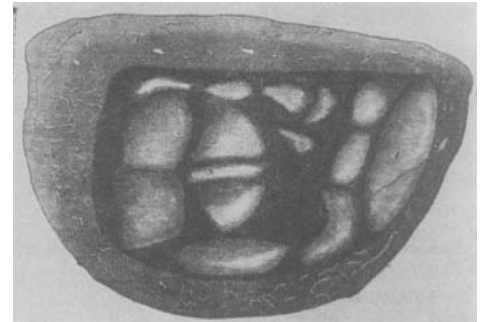
Gotta love us brown girls, munching on fat, swinging blue hips,
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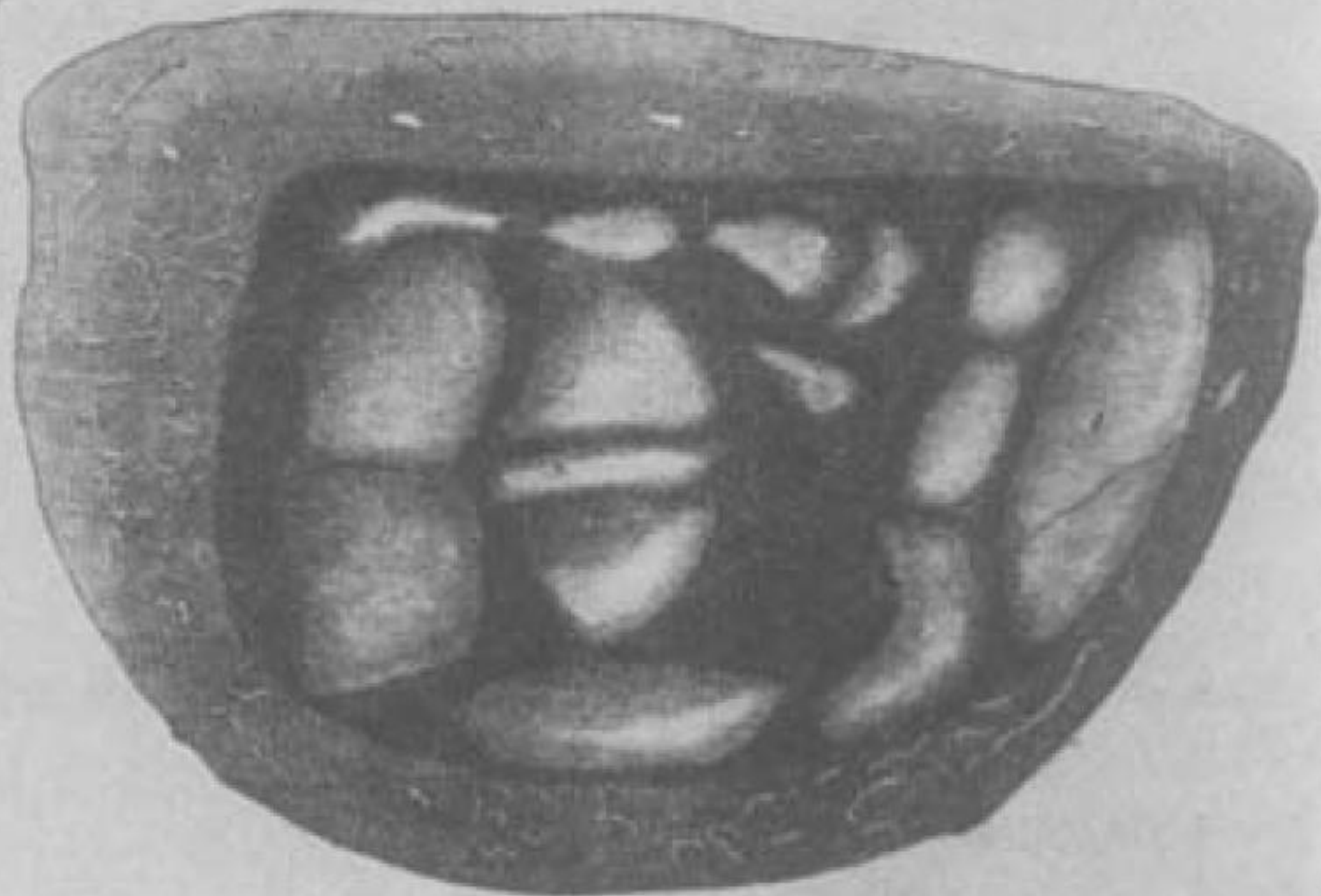
Mohammad Abdur Rahman Khan was arguably the most well-known name in Hyderabad in a certain field in pre-independent India. He had first become interested in them as a schoolboy at the Madrasa-i-Aliya in Hyderabad in the late 1880s.

Later, a development in 1910 reinvigorated his interest in the field. An eminent physicist of the times even borrowed some of the items from Khan's personal collection for X-ray analysis at his lab at Dhaka University. Additionally, Khan also attempted to find the origins of an object in West Asia using his expertise.

What fueled his interest? [3]

Which scientist? [4] What object? [3]





Answer Slide

The arrival of the Halley's Comet



Satyendra Nath Bose



The Black Stone of Ka'aba in Mecca



In the 19th century, senior British army officers wore hats that were adorned with oak leaves that had the appearance of being made of gold as a way to reflect their status.

While very few were made from actual gold, a less-expensive, lustrous alloy was used to give this appearance.

Which two-word term originates from this?



Answer Slide

Top Brass



The most important purpose behind this practice is to provide a medium for the energy absorption from all the impact forces by undergoing a temporary change in its contact relationship.

The other reasons include drainage of water, an even distribution of load, and the prevention of the growth of vegetation that can cause a potential problem. It is usually 0.5 meters thick, with a substantial 'shoulder' in place, to prevent lateral displacement and flooding. The item commonly used for this purpose in India is something that is named from Latin for its coarse texture.

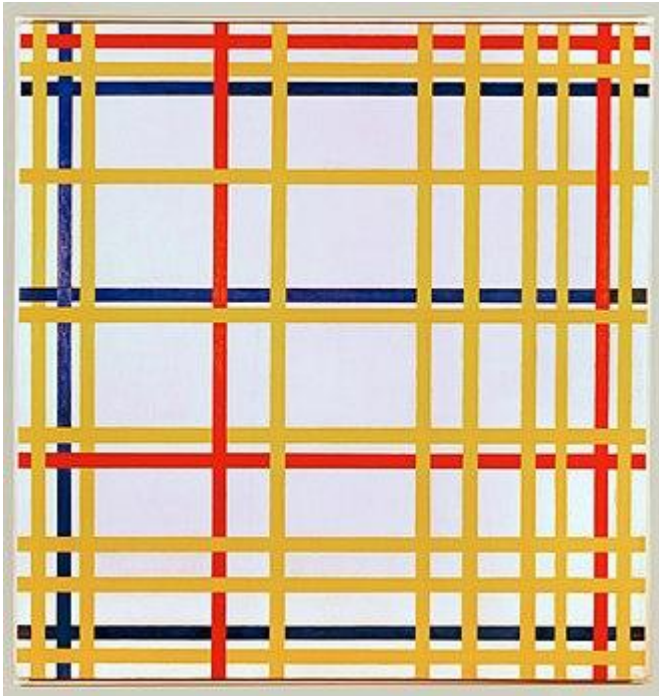
What practice are we talking about?

Answer Slide

Why you always see crushed stones (gravel) alongside railroad tracks
"gravis", meaning *heavy*



Connect



New York City 1, Piet Mondrian
(75 years)



La Bateau, Henri Matisse
(47 days)



Long Grass and Butterflies,
Van Gogh
(15 minutes)

Answer Slide

They were hung upside
down in galleries



St. Joseph's High School, Arpora, is Goa's first _____ school, started by Fr. William Lyons, a visiting British priest, in 1887.

Lyons was said to have been suffering from a skin ailment, and to cure it, he traveled all across India. Finally, someone advised him to go to Goa, where a particular spring in 'Siquerim' with medicinal properties would cure the disease. His ailment was cured, and as a token of gratitude, he started this school.

As the principal, he introduced an activity into the educational curriculum. This activity represented all the ideals of Christian manhood – discipline, strength etc.

What is St. Joseph's High, the first of in Goa? [5] What did he introduce? [5]

Answer Slide

First English school

Goa was a Portuguese colony in 1887



Goa's first English school to celebrate its 130th anniversary

Football



Round 3

- Written Round
- 4 questions
- Every correct answer fetches 10 points

What in the world of literature is the Hawking Index, popularized by American mathematician Jordan Ellenberg in his blog?

The bestseller *Fifty Shades of Grey* stands at 25.9

Hilary Clinton's *Hard Choices* is at 1.9

Which work is at 6.6, from which the index gets its name? [2 x 5]

The origin of this animal's name is Germanic and has been attributed largely to either Dutch or Old Norse. The Old Norse word for 'horse-whale' (not entirely inaccurate description of the creature itself) is thought to have passed in an inverted form (animal positions swapped) to both Dutch and German.

Several place names in Iceland, Greenland, and Norway may originate from breeding sites, such as Hvalfjord, Hvallatar, and Hvalsnes.

What animal? [10]

Minhwa is a folk art form practiced in a particular part of the world, and had its heyday from the 14th to the 20th centuries. These artworks were mostly made by anonymous craftsmen with no formal training and were believed to possess beneficial magical powers that protected their owners.

One recurring Minhwa motif is Hojakdo, which depicts two specific living things and symbolizes guarding against evil spirits and serves as a harbinger of good news.

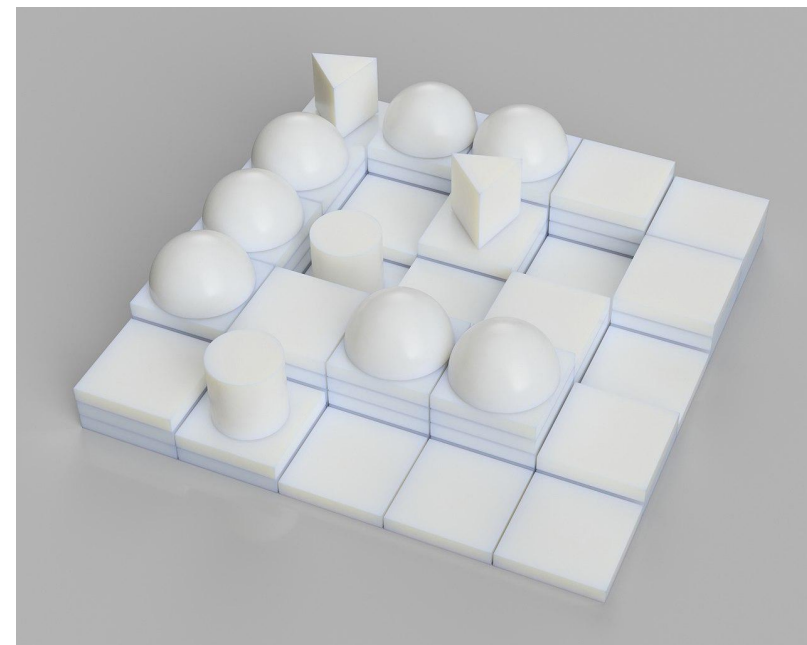
Why did souvenirs based on it see a huge rise in sales in 2025?

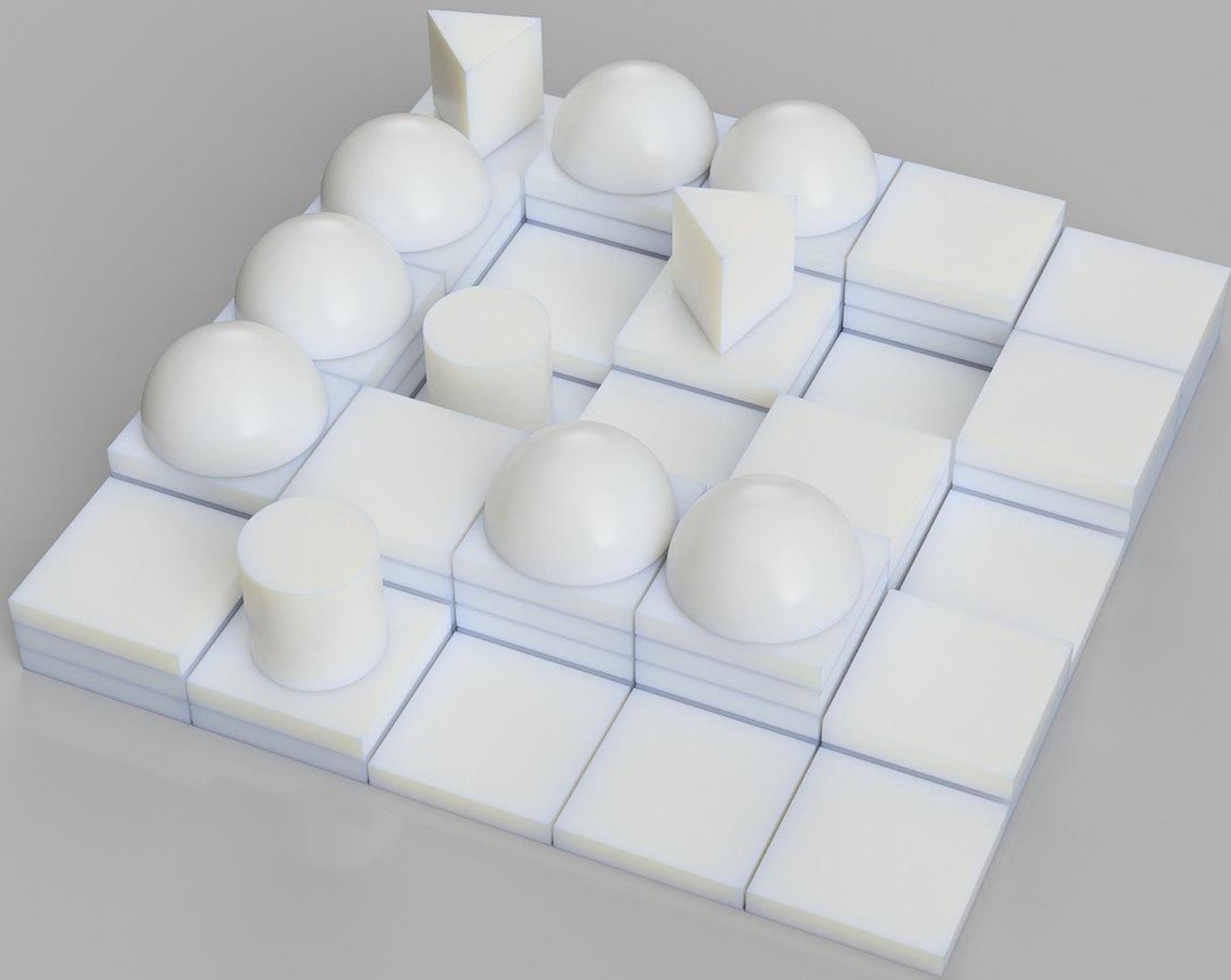




This is an abstract strategy board game for 2-4 players designed by Gordon Hamilton in 1985. He published the all-white wooden version in 2004.

What is the 1-word name of the game whose look and name is inspired by the architecture of cliffside villages on a certain European island?





Exchange Answers

What in the world of literature is the Hawking Index, popularized by American mathematician Jordan Ellenberg in his blog?

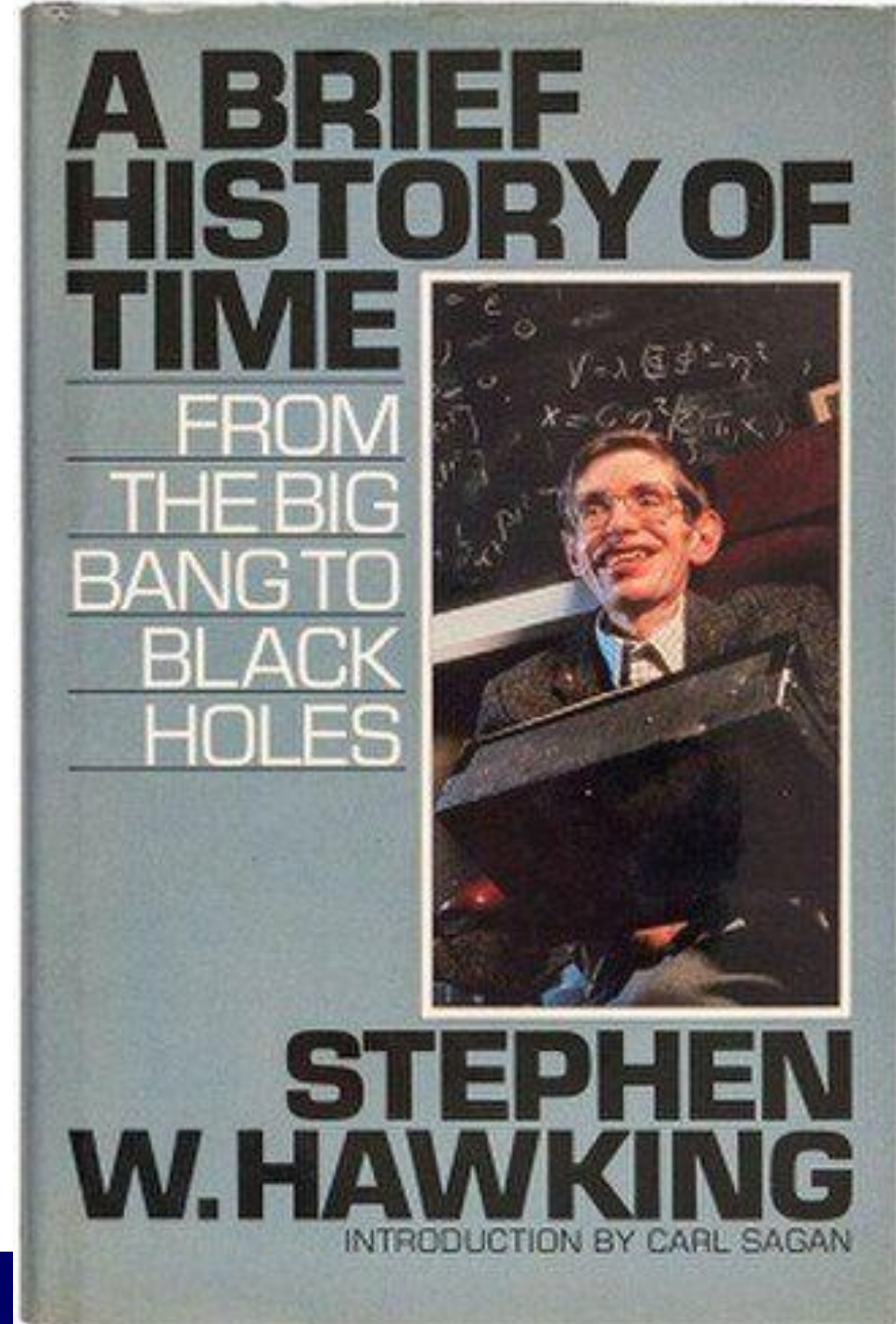
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Which work is at 6.6, from which the index gets its name? [2 x 5]

The Hawking Index is the measure of how far into a book a reader goes before giving up.

A Brief History of Time



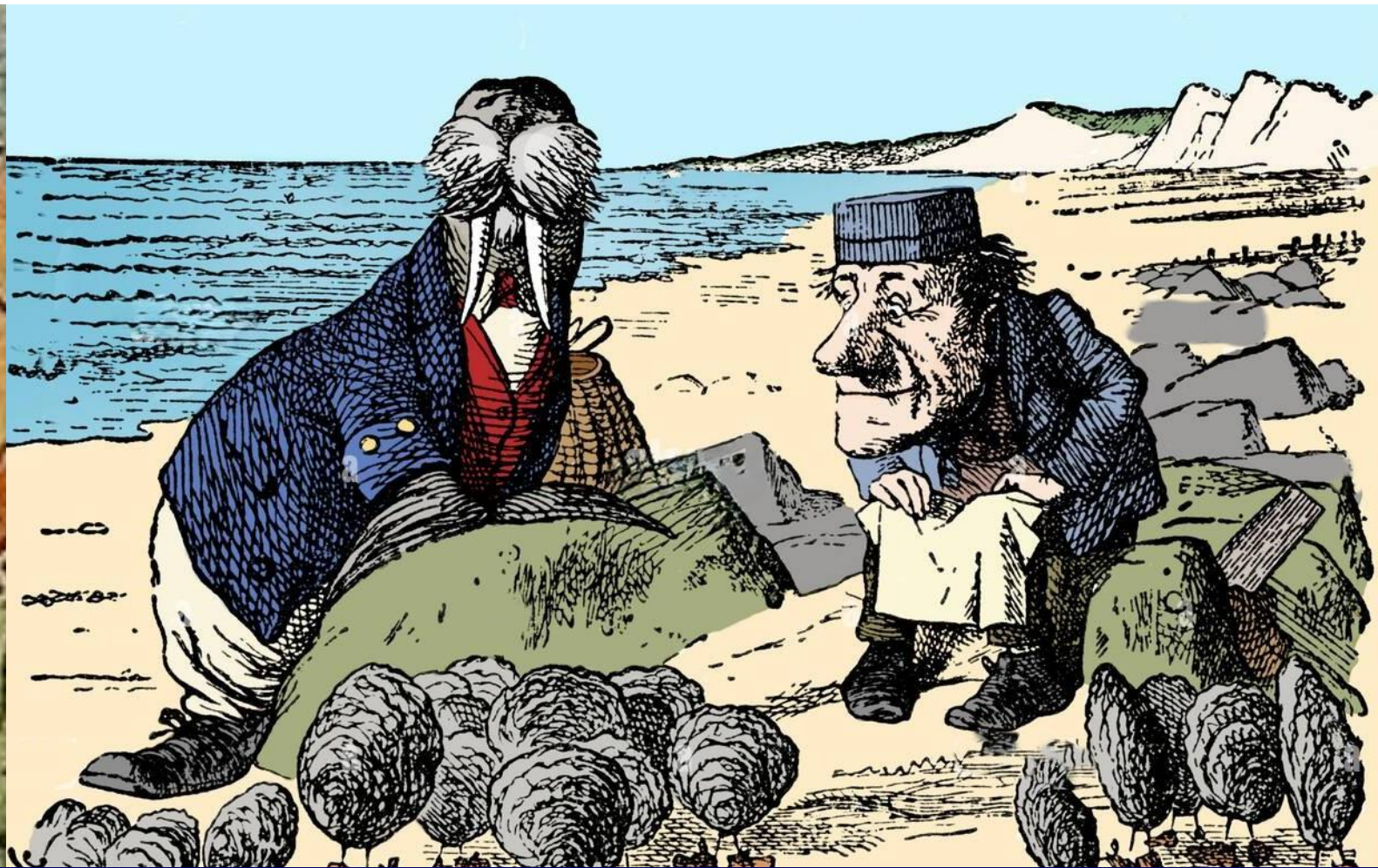
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Several place names in Iceland, Greenland, and Norway may originate from breeding sites, such as Hvalfjord, Hvallatar, and Hvalsnes.

What animal? [10]

Walrus

The Old Norse word hrosshvalr means 'horse-whale'



Minhwa is a folk art form practiced in a particular part of the world, and had its heyday from the 14th to the 20th centuries. These artworks were mostly made by anonymous craftsmen with no formal training and were believed to possess beneficial magical powers that protected their owners.

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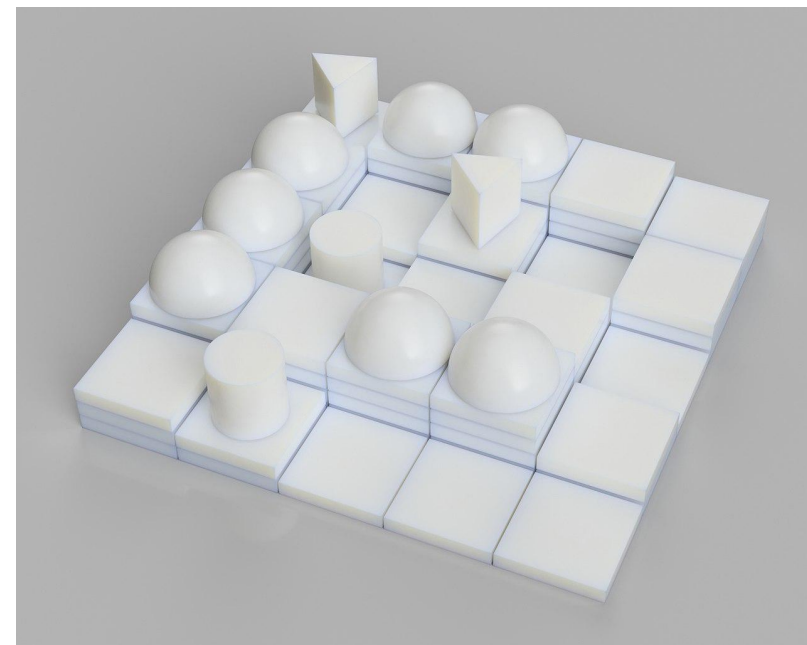


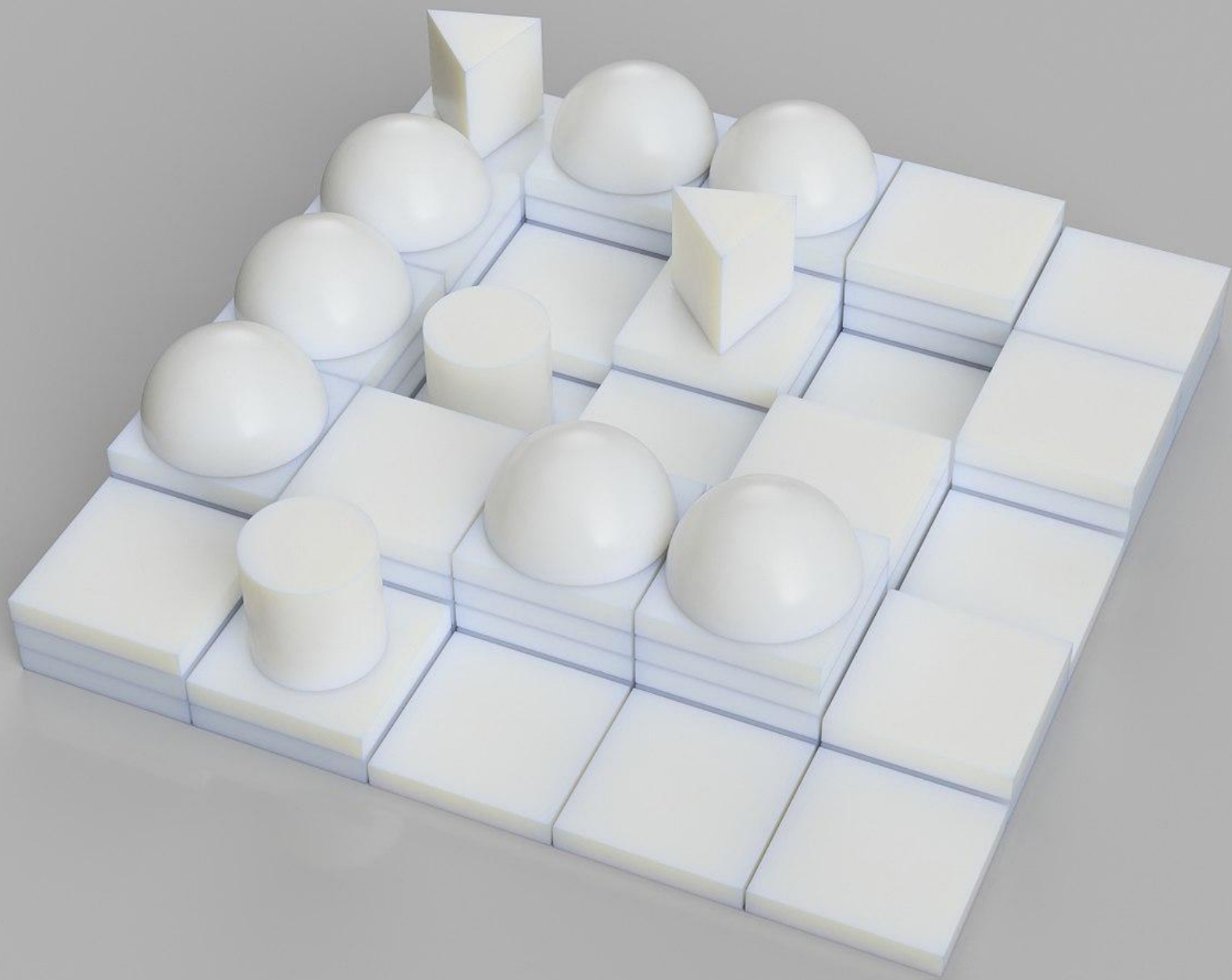
The magical tiger and magpie in *KPop Demon Hunters* were based on the Hojakdo motif



This is an abstract strategy board game for 2-4 players designed by Gordon Hamilton in 1985. He published the all-white wooden version in 2004.

What is the 1-word name of the game whose look and name is inspired by the architecture of cliffside villages on a certain European island?





Santorini



Round 4

- Anti-Clockwise Round
- 12 questions
- Bounce: +10/0
- Pounce: +10/-5

This geographical term was coined by the Spanish conquistador Vasco Núñez de Balboa in 1513 as he encountered something for the first time after crossing the Isthmus of Panama. If you looked at a map from far away, it would seem that the expression was a cardinal mistake, but if you zoomed into the section near Panama, Balboa's terminology makes sense.

What expression, which went on to become a somewhat generic term for "exotic" places like Oceania and Polynesia also?





Answer Slide

South Seas

The Isthmus of Panama runs east-west, and the canal actually runs north-south

South Sea Company



Arms of the South Sea Company: *Azure, a globe whereon are represented the Straits of Magellan and Cape Horn all proper and in sinister chief point two herrings haurient in saltire argent crowned or, in a canton the united arms of Great Britain*

On a chilly winter's night in 1845, he was returning home after a round of heavy drinking at a Glasgow pub. He either missed his footing or was too drunk to watch where he was going, but he tripped and fell into the ice-cold river.

As he pulled himself out of the water, he realized there was no way to describe how he was feeling then, and so began working on a way to quantify it.

What resulted? [5]

How did he pay tribute to the river that had a role to play in all this? [5]

Answer Slide

Absolute Zero, Renamed to Lord Kelvin

William Thomson chose to name himself Lord Kelvin after the river



The legend behind the Kodandarama temple in Hiremaglur, Karnataka, says that Parashurama's pride and anger were subdued by Rama at this spot. As a token of his devotion, Parashurama asked Rama to show him a certain form of his, which is why the representation of Rama, Lakshmana, and Sita in this temple does not conform to usual traditional representations of the trio.

What is different/uncommon about the representation of the trio at this temple? [5]

What form did Parashurama request Rama to show, which justifies this representation? [5]



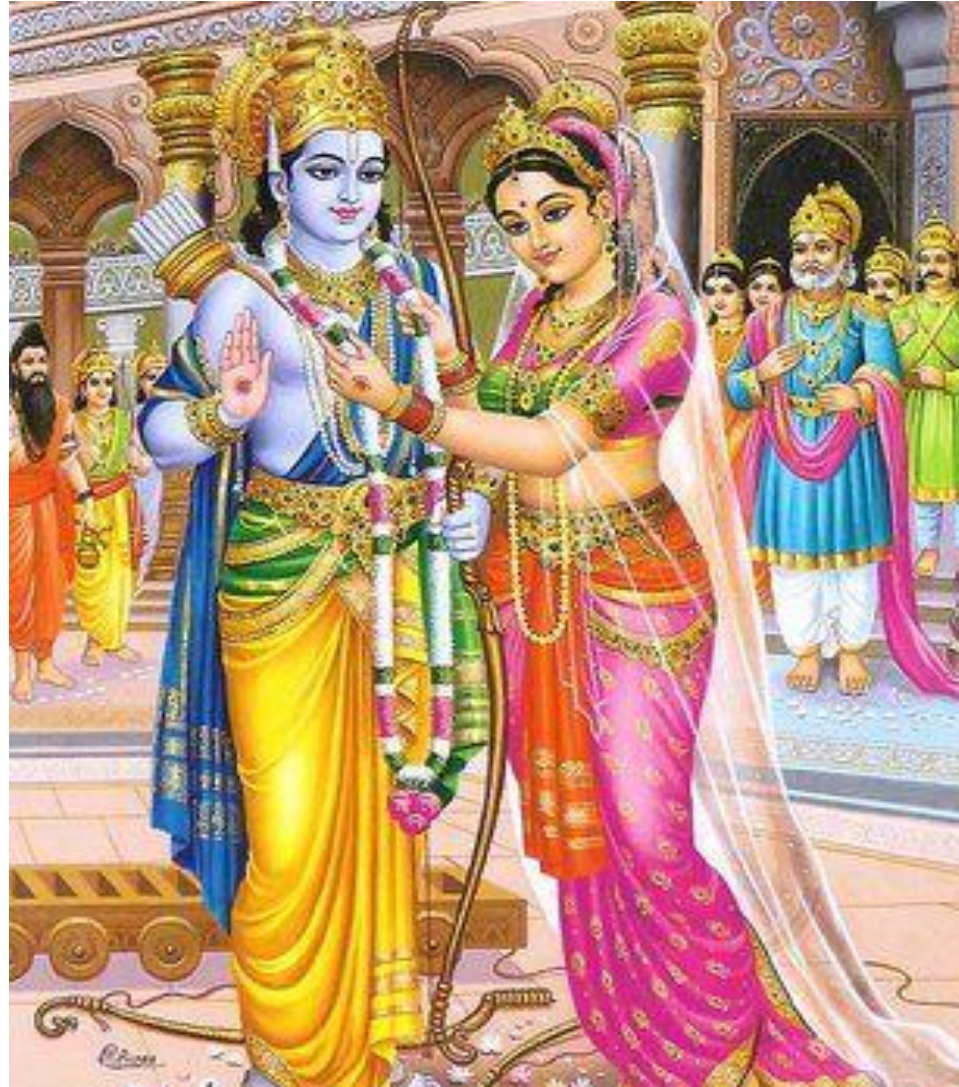
Answer Slide

Sita standing to the right of Rama

Traditionally, she's depicted on Rama's left



Parashurama requested Rama to show him the scene of his marriage



The suffix 'teen' is used in English to form the names of numbers from 13 to 19.

'Teen Series' is an informal term used to describe a set of four well-known products released over time by three different American companies. Interestingly, the earliest of these – chronologically - was the only ever exported to Iran. It also brought an unexpected windfall of \$1 million to the US government in the mid-1980s, thanks to a rather unconventional circumstance.

What is the 'Teen Series'? [5]

What was the source of the \$1 million? [5]

Answer Slide

Fourth-generation American combat aircraft
(F-14 Tomcat, F-15 Eagle, F-16 Fighting Falcon, F/A-18 Hornet)



The rent provided to the US Navy by the makers of *Top Gun*



In this sport, players typically hold the piece by the top, which is the standard grip.

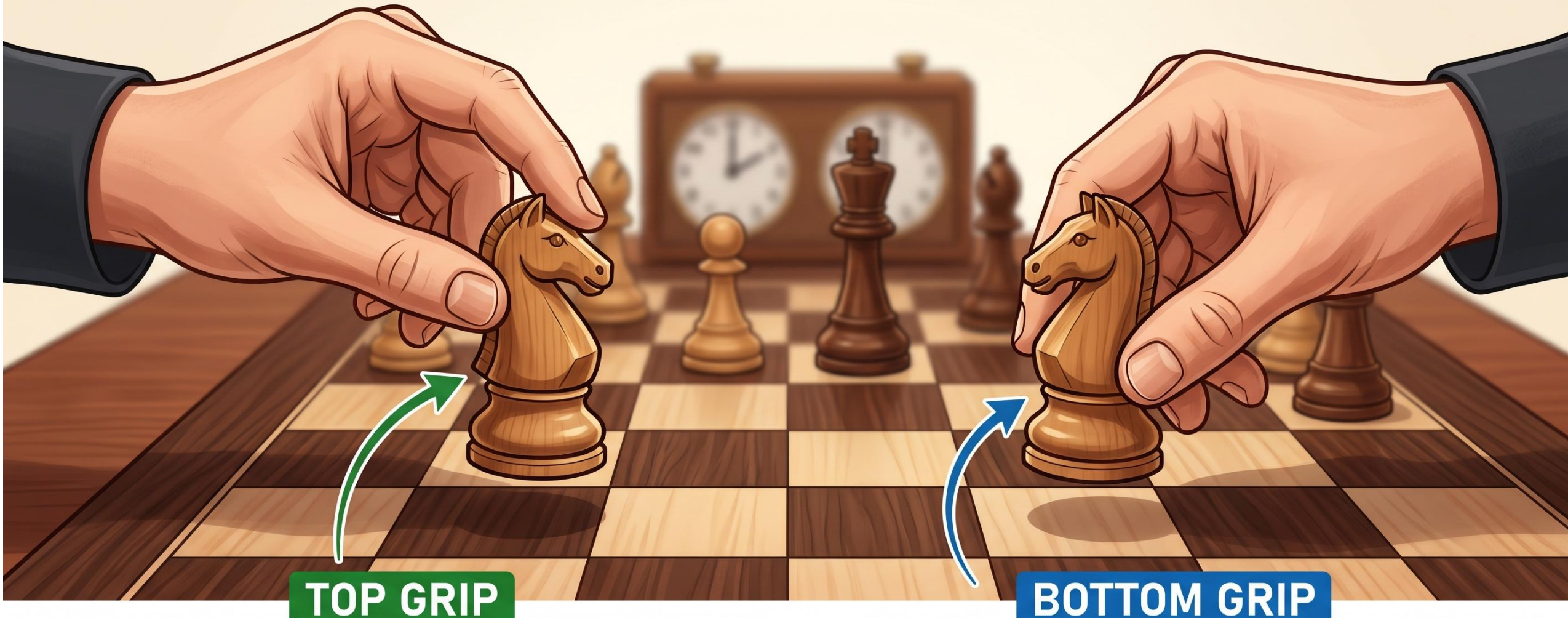
This grip is practical as it allows for easier lifting and placement without disturbing nearby pieces. In contrast, the bottom grip is considered stylistic and is less common among players.

Which sport? [10]

Answer Slide

Chess

CHESS PIECE GRIPS: TOP GRIP & BOTTOM GRIP



Chintayami Manasa is a collection of essays in which Gujarati writer Suresh Joshi provides critical commentary on a variety of topics, including the works of Sartre, Paz, Poulet, etc.

Upon being picked as the 1983 winner of the Sahitya Akademi Award, it drew criticism around originality - that it lacked the author's own critical thinking, instead relying on those of Western criticism.

The award wasn't eventually given, creating the only such instance in the history of the Sahitya Akademi.

Who opposed this award?

Answer Slide

He himself

This is the only time the award didn't go to the winner because the recipient refused to accept it, saying their own work wasn't deserving.



In the sample collected from the Ellora cave, scientists found a 10 percent share of something in the mix of mud or clay plaster.

This is the reason why no insect activity is found at Ellora. With these findings, it is no surprise that the set of 34 caves at Ellora, with their temples and monasteries, remain so well preserved. While at Ajanta, in the neighboring caves, signs of insect activity and degradation have been observed.

What botanical produce thus causes the difference between Ajanta and Ellora?

A familiar name, I'm sure.

Answer Slide

Cannabis sativa



CANNABIS / Weed has preserved ancient Indian artwork in the sacred Ellora Caves for 1,500 years

The pyramid hierarchy traditionally shows a wide base of junior employees supporting a small apex of senior leaders.

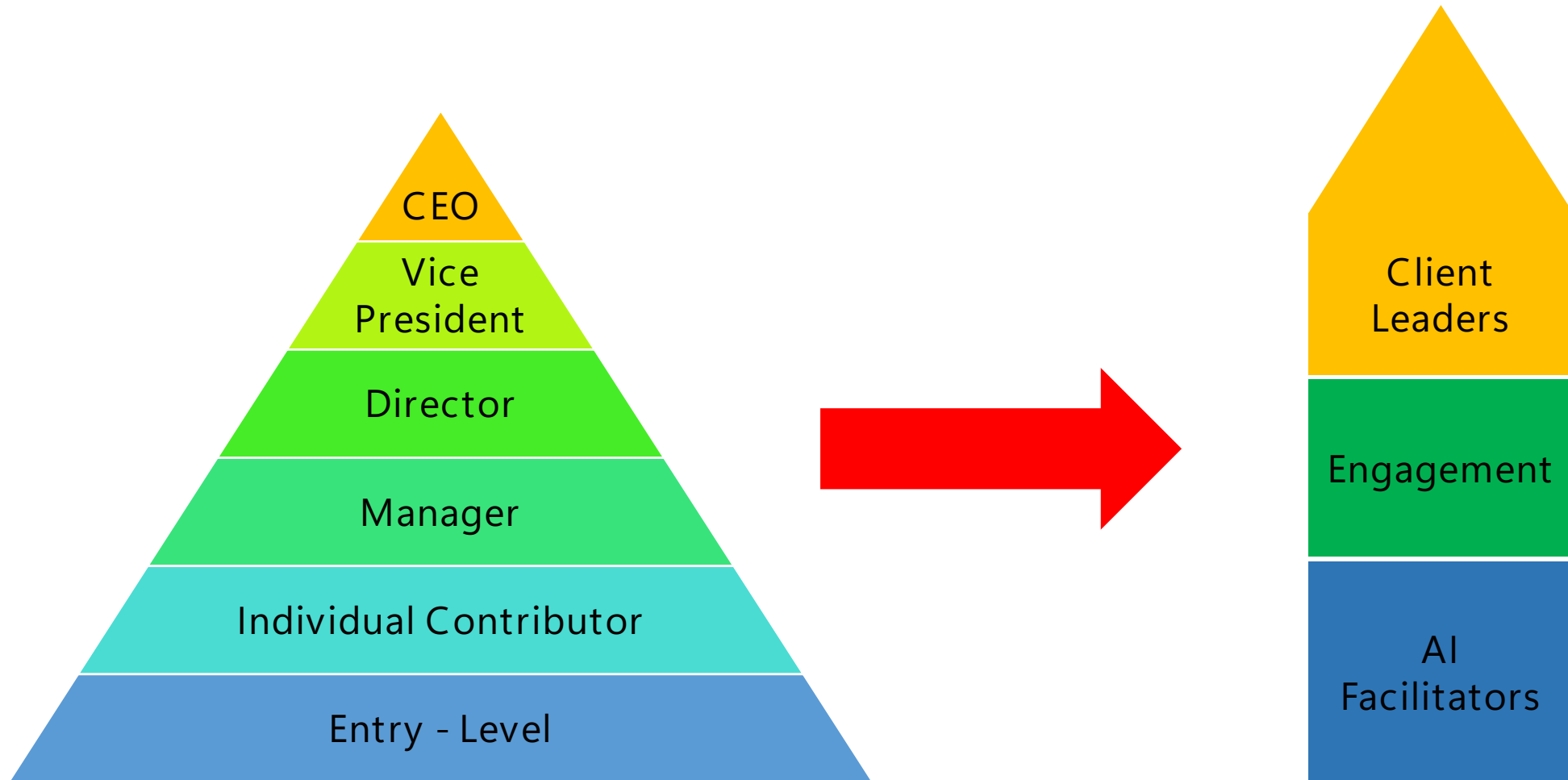
With AI now handling most entry-level tasks, the need for a large junior base is shrinking. As a result, this is now being reimagined as a similar, but leaner structure.

Which shape/structure is it being imagined as?



Answer Slide

Obelisk



"Ebony and Ivory" is a 1982 single by Paul McCartney featuring Stevie Wonder.

During the apartheid era, the South African Broadcasting Corporation banned the song after what specific gesture from Stevie Wonder, a couple of years later? [5]

The title of the song was inspired by a quote from Spike Milligan that Macca heard. What (that symbolized racial harmony) inspired it? [5]





Answer Slide

Wonder dedicated his 1984 Oscar to Nelson Mandela.



The song uses the ebony (black) and ivory (white) keys on a piano as a metaphor for racial harmony



He has played Ranji Trophy and List-A cricket for Madhya Pradesh (2017-2019) and was also part of the Rajasthan Royals squad from 2018-2019, albeit without any games.

The next slide shows a scorecard from a game he played alongside Rajat Patidar.

Who is being spoken of? (Full name) [10]

Madhya Pradesh 2nd Innings

BATTING		R	B	M	4s	6s	SR
	st †Bains b Gurvinder Singh	12	43	54	1	0	27.90
Anand Bais	st †Bains b Dagar	2	14	17	0	0	14.28
Rajat Patidar	c Guleria b Gurvinder Singh	54	101	160	8	0	53.46
Naman Ojha (c)†	c Gangta b Dagar	20	43	55	2	1	46.51

Answer Slide

Aryaman Birla



Score check

The 2013 film *Oonga* is a story of a little Adivasi boy's obsession with becoming Lord Rama (after watching a local play). The movie is set against the backdrop of corrupt land-mining activities threatening to destroy his village and the civil strife it leads to. So, he does something that also acts as a camouflage to rescue his village from the "bauxite mafia".

What aspect did he borrow from his hero? [5]

The story of *Oonga* found its seed in a small anecdote Devashish Makhija heard while in Koraput, Odisha. He recalls Sharanya Nayak, the local head of ActionAid there, telling him that she had taken a group of Adivasis to watch a dubbed version of a global blockbuster.

Which film? [5]

Answer Slide

Painted himself blue



Avatar



Before the last q...



Thank you BGQC!

Two nights together had these gentlemen
 Marcellus and Bernardo, on their watch (205)

In the dead vast and middle of the night,
 Been thus encountered. A figure like your father,
 Armed at point exactly, **cap-à-pie**,
 Appears before them, and with solemn march
 Goes slow and stately by them. Thrice he walk'd (210)
 By their oppress'd and fear-surprised eyes,
 Within his **truncheon's length**; whilst they, distill'd
 Almost to jelly with the act of fear,
 Stand dumb and speak not to him. This to me

What is the source of these lines? [3]

What does the highlighted phrase literally mean? [4]

An Indian company with this name today globally dominates the apparel space for this sport.

Which sport? [3]



Makes It Easy

Answer Slide

Hamlet; head-to-foot; shooting





That's all folks!

Tie Breakers

- Sudden death
- Pounce:+1/-1

Starting with Mombasa, Kenya, in 1953, this Indian bank, named after a wealthy princely state, currently has over 80 overseas branches, contributing approximately 15.91% to its total business.

One of its most significant foreign branches was opened in 1976 in a European capital city to facilitate international trade for a specific type of business from Bombay and Surat.

Which business & which bank?

Men with Brooms is a Canadian rom-com that tells the story of a team from a small Canadian town as they work through their personal issues and struggle to win the championship for the sake of their late coach.

Which sport?